

ReBait: From Clickbait to Informed Choice in Live News Recommendation Feeds

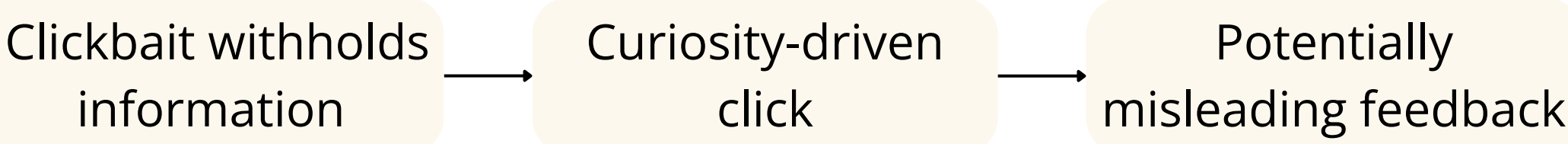
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Demo & Paper

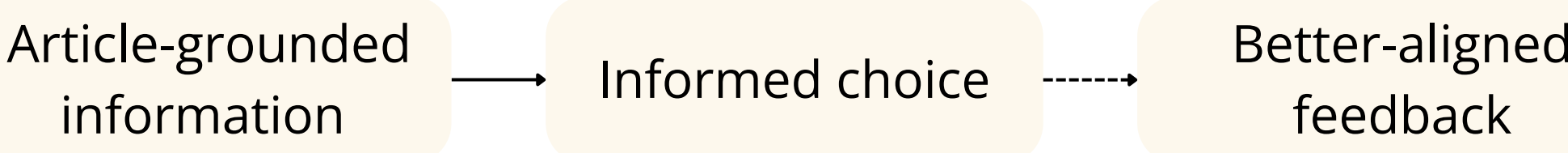
The Problem

- **Clicks do not always reflect content preference.**
- Clickbait can trigger curiosity-driven clicks by withholding key information. As a result, a click may reflect the headline's presentation rather than satisfaction with the article.

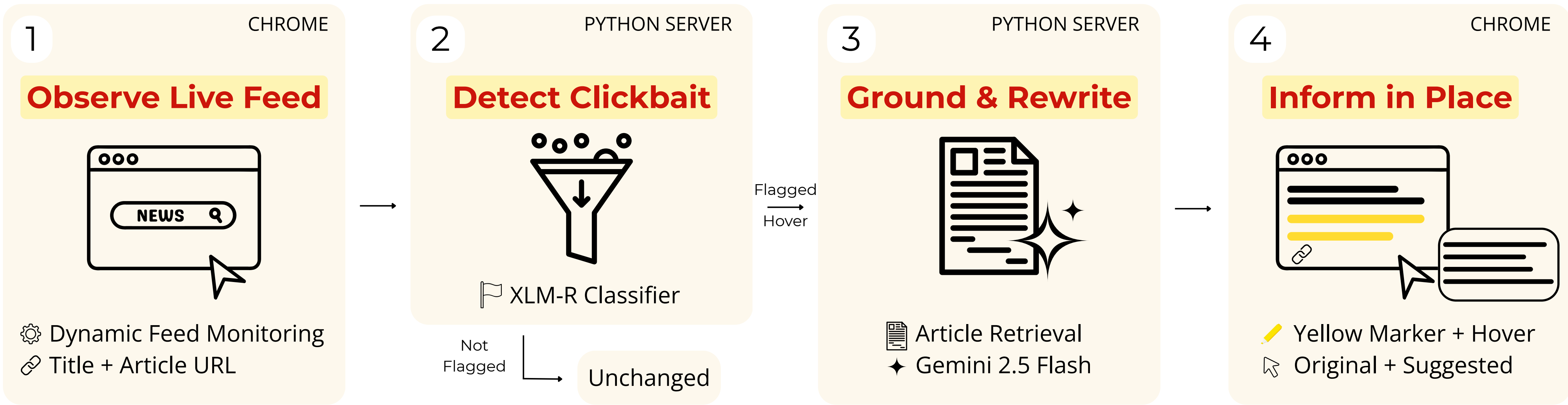


Our Approach

- **ReBait reveals article-grounded information before the click.**
- ReBait intervenes after ranking and before user choice, aiming to better align clicks with content satisfaction and the implicit feedback used for future recommendations.



How ReBait Works



ReBait in Action

Live demonstration shown on Upworthy

Preserved Browsing

ReBait preserves the publisher's original headline, destination link, and feed order. Users can browse and follow links as usual.

Selective Intervention

Hovering over a headline flagged as potential clickbait triggers article retrieval and rewriting. Unflagged headlines remain unchanged.

Original

Passenger on 274-day cruise is surprised to learn the one word you can't say on the ship

Suggested headline

TikToker learns not to say "Titanic" on a cruise ship after mentioning it at lunch

Inspectable Comparison

The panel presents the original headline alongside an article-grounded suggestion, making the added information inspectable before the user decides whether to click.

Contributions

- **An Integrated Cross-Site Pipeline.**

ReBait combines dynamic feed monitoring, clickbait detection, article retrieval, and article-grounded headline generation. The original system was deployed across five Taiwanese news websites.

- **An Inspectable Choice-Time Intervention.**

ReBait makes headline framing and article-grounded information jointly inspectable without publisher cooperation, ranker access, or user histories. Its contribution is the deployable composition rather than a new classifier.

Future Work

- **Validate Detection.**

Evaluate clickbait detection on Chinese news headlines across outlets and headline styles using human annotations.

- **Assess Rewrite Quality.**

Evaluate faithfulness, clarity, and informativeness, including whether suggested headlines resolve information gaps without introducing unsupported claims.

- **Study User and Recommender Impact.**

Measure effects on informed choice, post-click satisfaction, and interaction behavior, and examine their implications for recommendation feedback.